

TO BE Negative, A/An, and WH- Questions

English Lab · Session 3 · Level Pre-A1



Recap: Answering Greetings and Introducing Yourself with 'To Be'

What We Remember

- We answer greetings like "*How are you?*" with "**I'm fine, thanks!**" or "**I'm doing well.**"
- Verb **TO BE** means *ser* or *estar* to state identity, city origin, job, and feelings.
- Affirmative forms: **I am (I'm), you are (you're), he/she/it is, and we/they are.**

Quick Check: How do you introduce your name and city using affirmative 'to be'?



Quick Warm-Up Quiz

Choose the correct form of the verb TO BE: 'She _____ happy today.'

1.

be

2.

am

3.

is

4.

are

Quick Warm-Up Quiz



Choose the correct form of the verb TO BE: 'She _____ happy today.'

1.

be

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4.

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Learning Objectives

Objectives

1

Make negative statements using **am / is / are + not** with full and contracted forms.

2

Choose **a** or **an** accurately based on the initial sound of the following singular noun.

3

Ask and answer essential **WH-questions** to exchange basic personal information in conversations.

Key Vocabulary

Key words



Not - Makes a sentence negative or denies a fact.



What - Asks about things, objects, or actions.



Where - Asks about places, locations, or origin.



Who - Asks about a person or people.



Forming the Negative: Add 'Not'

In English, to make a statement negative, we place the word **not** directly after the verb **to be**. The basic structure is: **Subject + to be + not + complement**.

In Spanish, you say *"Yo no soy doctor."* In English, never say *"I no am doctor."* The word **not** must always follow **am**, **is**, or **are**: *"I am not a doctor."*

Negative Forms and Contractions

KEY CONCEPT

I · First Person

Full form: I am not

Contraction: I'm not

Example: I'm not tired today.

You / We / They

Full form: are not

Contractions: aren't / you're not

Example: We aren't ready yet.

He / She / It

Full form: is not

Contractions: isn't / she's not

Example: She isn't in the office.



Mistake to avoid

There is no contraction like "**amn't**".
The only correct short form is "**I'm not**".

Contrasting False and True Facts

When meeting new colleagues, we often correct mistaken information by combining a **negative statement** with a **positive statement**.

- **Profession:** *"I am not a doctor. I am an engineer."*
- **Origin:** *"Carlos isn't from Spain. He is from Colombia."*
- **Emotion:** *"We aren't nervous. We are confident."*



Negative Form Practice

Which sentence is grammatically correct in English?

1.

She is no a doctor. She is a teacher.

2.

She not is a doctor. She is a teacher.

3.

She isn't a doctor. She is a teacher.

4.

She no is a doctor. She is a teacher.

Negative Form Practice

Which sentence is grammatically correct in English?



1. She is no a doctor. She is a teacher.

2. She not is a doctor. She is a teacher.

3. She isn't a doctor. She is a teacher.

4. She no is a doctor. She is a teacher.



The Indefinite Articles: A and An



Use 'A'

Use **a** before singular nouns that begin with a **consonant sound**.

Examples: a book, a desk, a student, a city.



Use 'An'

Use **an** before singular nouns that begin with a **vowel sound** (a, e, i, o, u).

Examples: an apple, an engineer, an office, an actor.

Sound Over Spelling

Listen to the spoken sound, not the written letter.



The article rule in English depends completely on the **first sound** when spoken aloud, never the written spelling:

- **Silent 'H':** *an hour* (sounds like "our" with a vowel sound, so use **an**).
- **Voiced 'H':** *a house, a hospital* (the 'h' is pronounced as a consonant).
- **'U' sounding like 'Y':** *a university, a user* (starts with the consonant sound /j/).



Tip

Say the noun out loud. If your vocal cords start with an open vowel sound, use **an**.

When Not to Use A or An

Singular vs. Plural and Uncountable

Both **a** and **an** mean *one* (singular). Because of this meaning, they can never be used with plural or uncountable items:

- **Plural nouns:** Say *"They are students"* (never *"a students"*).
- **Uncountable nouns:** Say *"I need water"* or *"some coffee"* (never *"a water"*).
- **Nationalities:** Say *"She is Colombian"* (adjective) or *"She is a Colombian student"*.



Article Challenge

Which phrase correctly uses 'a' or 'an'?

1. a hour

2. an hour

3. a apple

4. an university

Article Challenge

Which phrase correctly uses 'a' or 'an'?



1.

a hour

2.

an hour



3.

a apple

4.

an university

Video: Introductions and Questions in Action



A video thumbnail featuring a woman with long brown hair, wearing a dark grey t-shirt, smiling at the camera. The background is a light-colored wall with a small potted plant and a globe visible. The video title 'Simple Present' is displayed in white text on a blue banner at the top. Below the title, the word 'Be' is written in large blue letters with a white outline, followed by '(verb)' in smaller blue letters. To the right of 'Be' is a large blue curly brace containing the words 'am', 'is', and 'are' stacked vertically. In the bottom left corner, the text 'Part 1' is written in white on a pink background.

Simple Present

Be { am
(verb) is
are

Part
1

Asking with Purpose: WH-Questions

When we want real information beyond a simple "yes" or "no", we begin with a **WH-word**.

Every WH-word has a specific target: people, things, places, or descriptions. Mastering them unlocks genuine two-way conversation.



Core WH-Words for Introductions



What

Asks for objects or information.

"What is your name?"



Where

Asks for place or origin.

"Where are you from?"



Who

Asks for a person's identity.

"Who is your teacher?"



How

Asks for condition, manner, or age.

"How are you? / How old are you?"

Sentence Structure for WH-Questions

KEY CONCEPT



1. WH-Word

Start with **What, Where, Who,** or **How.**

2. Verb TO BE

Add the correct form of *to be*: **is** or **are.**

3. Subject

End with the subject (*you, she*) and **?**.

Connecting Questions to Meaning

City & Country

"Where are you from?"

I am from Colombia.

Name & Identity

"What is your name?"

My name is Carlos.

Age & Status

"How old are you?"

I am 24 years old.

Match the WH-Words

Match the words with the definitions

Where

Asks for a person's age in years

What

Asks about a person's identity

How old

Asks for a place, city, or country of origin

Who

Asks for an object or specific information

Match the WH-Words

Match the words with the definitions



Where

What

How old

Who

A

Asks for a person's age in years

B

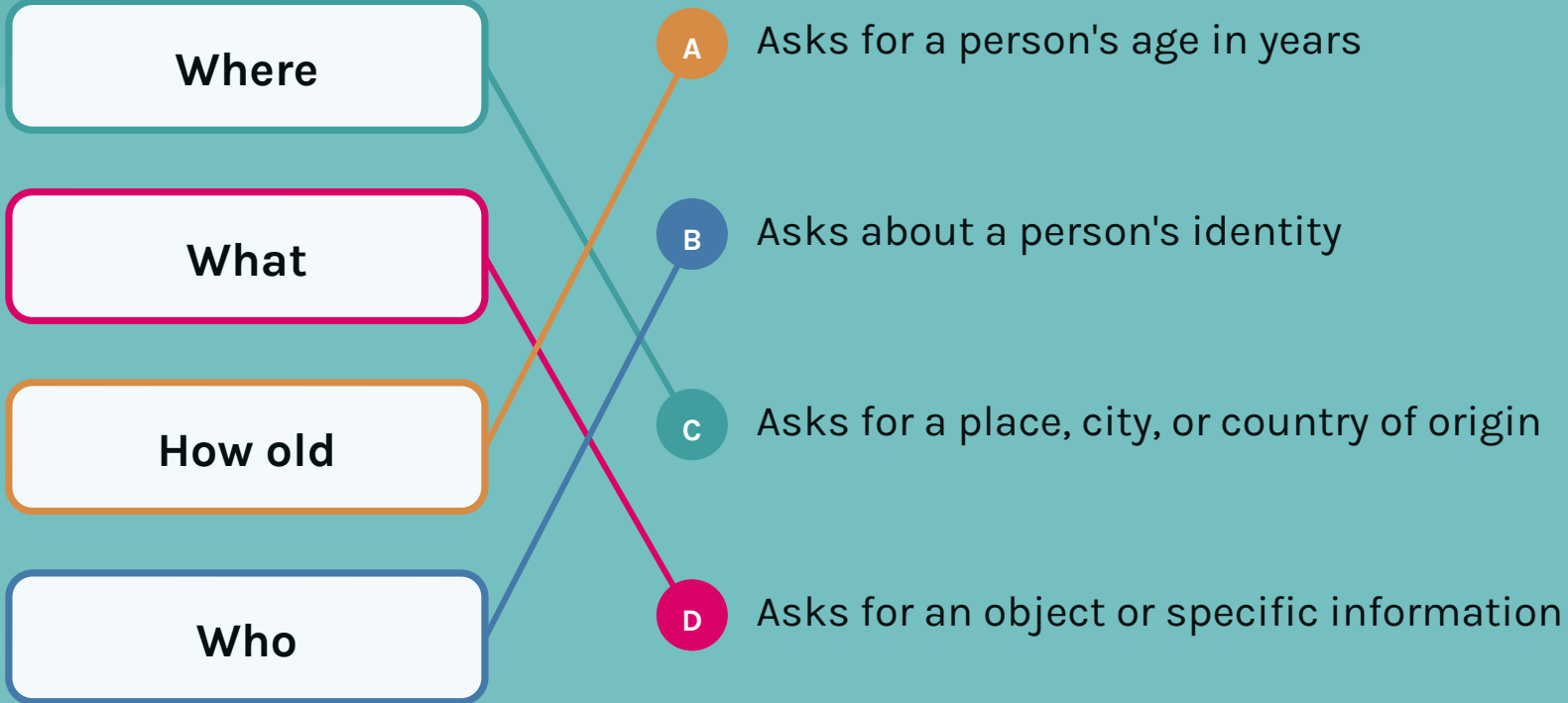
Asks about a person's identity

C

Asks for a place, city, or country of origin

D

Asks for an object or specific information



Model Exchange: Meeting a New Classmate

Notice how questions, articles, and negative corrections work together smoothly:



Listening: Introducing Carolina

Listen to the audio and answer the questions



Carolina introduces herself



Play audio

1

Where is Carolina from?

2

How old is Carolina?

3

What is Carolina's job?

4

Is Carolina a doctor?

Listening: Introducing Carolina

Check your answers below



Carolina introduces herself

 **Play audio**

- 1 She is from Cali, Colombia.
- 2 She is twenty-eight years old.
- 3 She is an engineer.
- 4 No, she is not a doctor.

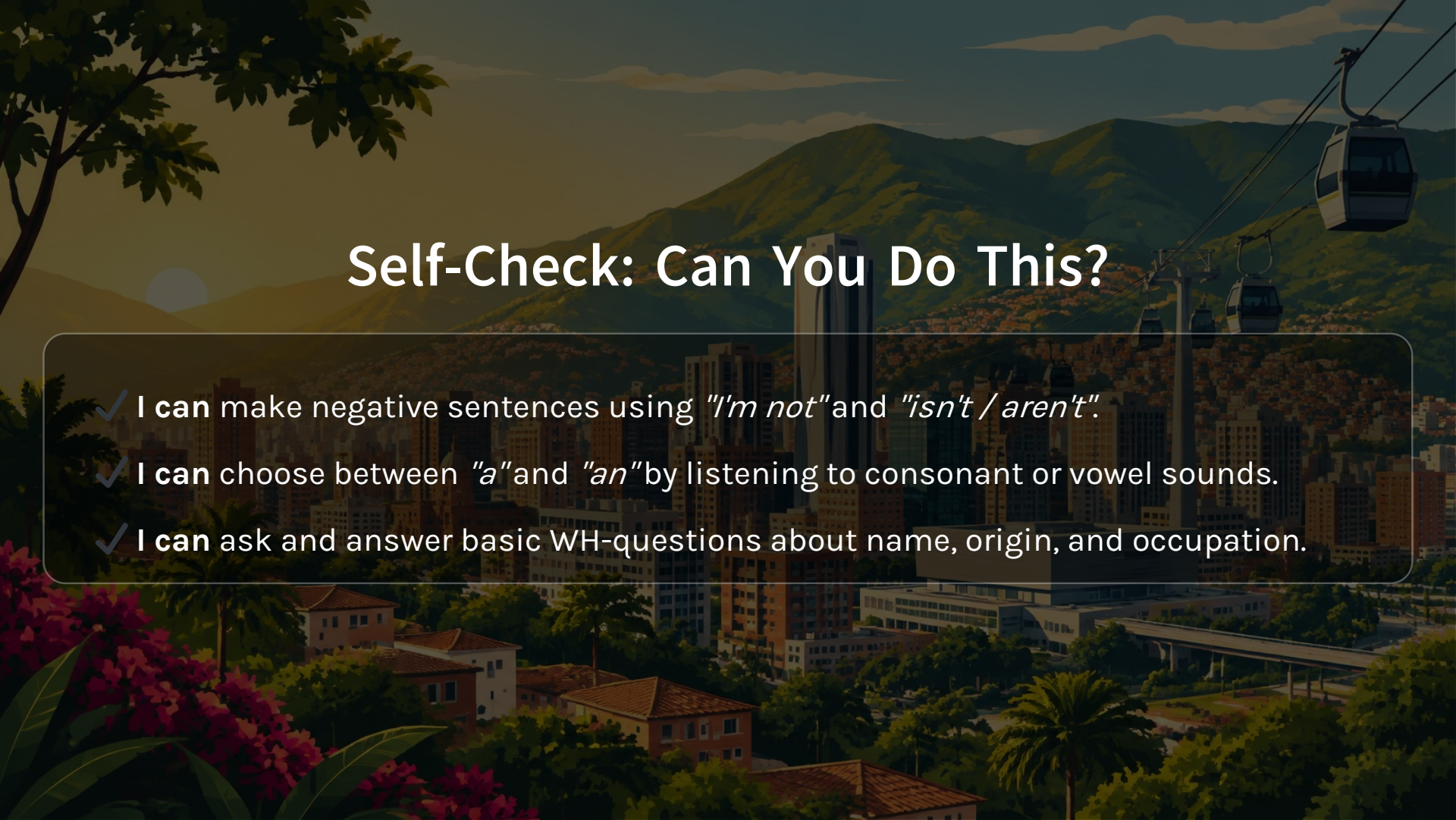
Guided Speaking: Role-Play

Pair Dialogue Practice

Work with a partner. Take turns asking and answering these three fundamental questions:

- **A:** *"What is your name?"* → **B:** *"My name is..."*
- **A:** *"Where are you from?"* → **B:** *"I am from..."*
- **A:** *"Are you an architect?"* → **B:** *"No, I'm not. I am a..."*





Self-Check: Can You Do This?

- ✓ I **can** make negative sentences using *"I'm not"* and *"isn't / aren't"*.
- ✓ I **can** choose between *"a"* and *"an"* by listening to consonant or vowel sounds.
- ✓ I **can** ask and answer basic WH-questions about name, origin, and occupation.

Check Your Understanding



Question 1:

Complete the negative sentence: 'I _____ tired today.'

Question 2:

Choose 'a' or 'an': 'She works in _____ office.'

Question 3:

Which WH-word asks about origin: '_____ are you from?'

Check Your Understanding



Answer 1:

am not (or I'm not)

Answer 2:

an

Answer 3:

Where

Looking Ahead to Session 4

Excellent work today! In our next class, we will expand our conversational toolkit even further:

- **Numbers 0 to 100:** Counting, ages, and dates.
- **Phone numbers:** Saying and understanding numbers digit by digit.
- **Oral production:** Asking and replying in full personal information exchanges.

See you next class! Keep practicing!



Final Exit Ticket



Introduce yourself to your partner:
state your name, your city, one thing
you are not, and ask them where they
are from.

Final Exit Ticket



You might have said...

Example response: 'Hello! My name is David. I am from Cali. I am not a doctor, I am an accountant. Where are you from?'